

A note to the Clark Howard team

To: Clark Howard show / team (via clark.com contact form, or the show's listener/press email)

From: Rob Brizzi · brizzi78@icloud.com · thecardinalspromise.com

Purpose: Courtesy note + permission ask — his consumer-protection work is credited in a caregiver book.

Subject: Your "gift cards = scam" rule is helping caregivers — a thank-you and a small ask

Hi Clark (and team),

I'm a longtime listener, and I wanted to say thank you before I ask anything. I've spent my career in home health, hospice, and senior living, sitting with families in hospital hallways and living rooms as they tried to care for an aging parent. I've just finished a practical guide for those families — *It's Not Your Fault: Helping Caregivers with Aging Loved Ones*.

One of the hardest things I watch families face is financial exploitation of a parent whose memory is starting to slip. When I wrote that section, your work was on my mind — especially the one rule you've hammered for years that cuts through almost every scam at once:

"No legitimate business or government agency will ever ask to be paid in gift cards."

That line has saved real people real money. I credited your consumer-protection work in the book — as an influence, not an endorsement — in two short places and in a brief "A Note of Thanks." I wanted you to hear it directly from me rather than stumble on it, and to make sure you're comfortable with how you're mentioned. If anything reads wrong to you, I'll change it immediately.

The small ask: if you're ever willing to take a look at the passage, I'd be honored to send it. And if the book strikes you as genuinely useful for the caregivers in your audience, I'd welcome a line of feedback — with no expectation at all. Either way, thank you for the decades of plain, honest guidance. It shows up in kitchens and at bedsides more than you probably know.

Warmly,

Rob Brizzi, CDP

Author, *It's Not Your Fault* · Founder, The Cardinal's Promise

brizzi78@icloud.com · thecardinalspromise.com

HOW TO SEND IT

Clark Howard doesn't publish a personal email, and that's normal. Best routes, in order: (1) the contact form at **clark.com** (look for "Contact" / "Ask Clark"); (2) the show's listener line or press/media email if listed; (3) a short LinkedIn note to a producer or the Clark.com editorial team. Keep it to this one page. Attach the book's one-page summary or the scam section as a PDF only if a reply invites it — don't lead with attachments.

IF THEY SAY YES

A "happy to take a look" opens the door to a real endorsement blurb — far more valuable than any dedication. If that happens, get the exact wording they approve in writing (a simple email is fine), and only then move his name anywhere prominent like the cover or an ad.

Draft only — not sent. This is a courtesy/permission outreach, not legal advice. The book credits Clark Howard as an influence (attribution), which needs no permission; a cover mention, dedication, or marketing use of his name would — so wait for written approval before going there.

Cardinal Promise Press · *It's Not Your Fault: Helping Caregivers with Aging Loved Ones* by Rob Brizzi, CDP, with Hope Brizzi, PharmD · thecardinalspromise.com